Source: ABC News
Wednesday 11 November 2026

Regulators target dodgy discounts and opaque private credit

> With Black Friday spending forecast to hit a record **A$7.2 billion**, the **ACCC** is watching for fake 'discounts'. Separately, **ASIC** has criticised the A$250 billion private credit sector for poor disclosure.

WHAT HAPPENED

- Black Friday to Cyber Monday (27–30 November) spending is forecast at a record **A$7.2bn**, up 5.5%. Average planned spend is **A$920** per shopper, up 14.4%.
- The **ACCC** is targeting misleading discount claims. Six retailers have been fined a combined **A$217,800** over two years.
- **ASIC**'s second review of the **A$250bn private credit** sector found poor disclosure to investors and firms resisting the regulator's instructions.

Information asymmetry: one side of a deal (the seller) knows more than the other
ACCC: enforces competition and consumer law
ASIC: regulates financial markets and products

KEY NUMBERS

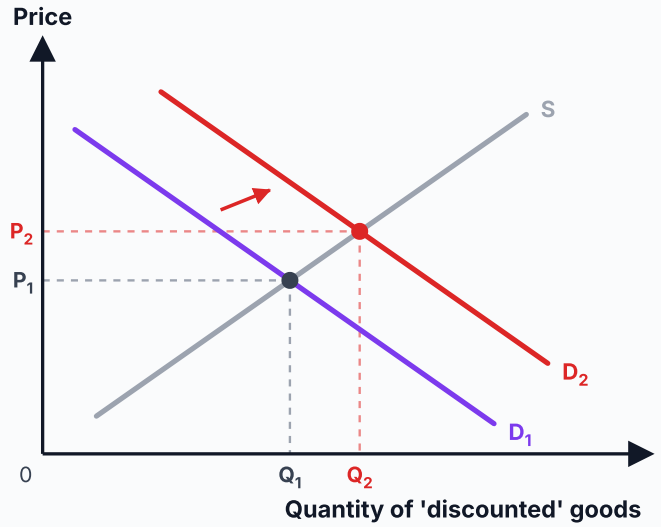
A$7.2bn
Forecast Black Friday–Cyber Monday spend

A$920
Average planned spend per shopper

A$217,800
Combined fines for 6 retailers over 2 years

A$250bn
Size of the private credit sector

DIAGRAM — Misleading 'discounts' distort consumer choices



D_1 shows demand when consumers know the true value of a deal. A fake 'was' price makes the deal look better, so demand inflates to D_2.

Consumers buy Q_2 instead of Q_1 and pay P_2: resources go to goods people would not have chosen with accurate information.

Consumer law aims to keep demand at D_1 by keeping price claims honest.

Exam angle: **information asymmetry** is a market failure. Competition and consumer protection policy is part of **microeconomic reform** that improves allocative efficiency.

COMPARE — Two regulators, one goal: well-informed markets

ACCC: product markets
- Enforces competition and consumer law
- Targets misleading prices and 'discounts'
- Fines and court action against retailers

ASIC: financial markets
- Regulates investment products and advisers
- Reviewing the A$250bn private credit sector
- Demands clearer disclosure to investors

SYLLABUS LINK

Topic 4 – microeconomic policy: competition policy and consumer protection; financial regulation. Topic 3 – market failure (information asymmetry).

TRY THIS

Explain how regulators such as the ACCC can improve the efficiency of markets.
(3 MARKS)

ABC News – Pre-Christmas shoppers warned of dodgy discounts in Black Friday sales: https://www.abc.net.au/news/2026-11-10/shoppers-warned-dodgy-discounts-black-friday-sales/107365588
ABC News – ASIC slams $250 billion private credit sector: https://www.abc.net.au/news/2026-11-10/asic-slam-250-billion-dollar-private-credit-sector/107365226
ABC News – Markets live blog, 10 Nov 2026: https://www.abc.net.au/news/2026-11-10/asx-markets-business-live-news-november-10-2026/107363300

Diagrams are illustrative, not to scale